

Why is it called Bluetooth?

Harald Bluetooth (Harald Blåtand in Danish) was king of Denmark in the late 900s. He united Denmark and part of Norway into a single kingdom. Choosing this name for the standard indicates how important companies from the Scandinavian region (nations including Denmark, Sweden, Norway and Finland) are to the communications industry, even if it says little about the way the technology works.

let the devices search for and find each other. Then you need to enter a common pass key, decided by you, in both devices.

An increasing number of mid-range mobile phones and almost all high-end mobile phones and handhelds now boast of the Bluetooth feature. Bluetooth is also available as an integrated feature on many notebook models as well.

Wi-Fi

Wi-Fi is short for wireless fidelity and is meant to be used generically when referring to any type of 802.11 network. The Wi-Fi trademark is controlled by the Wi-Fi Alliance (formerly the Wireless Ethernet Compatibility Alliance), the trade organisation that tests and certifies equipment compliance with the IEEE 802.11 standards.

Wi-Fi allows mobile devices, such as laptop computers and PDAs, to connect to local area networks (LANs). It is also used for Internet access and wireless VoIP phones. The connection is made by radio signals and there is no need to plug the device into a network point. A wireless access point is required to create a wireless network of Wi-Fi devices. The geographical area covered by one or more access points is called a hotspot.

Desktop computers can also use Wi-Fi, allowing offices and homes to be networked without expensive wiring.